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Indian National Movement: 1905-18

PARTITION OF BENGAL (1905)

"Real Awakening in India took place only after the Partition of Bengal."
-M. K. Gandhi"

In July 1905, **Lord Curzon** announced the partition of the undivided Bengal Presidency. It was implemented on October 16, 1905.

It proposed the following:

- **Two Provinces:**
 - Bengal was divided into two provinces: **Western Bengal (with Bihar and Orissa)** and **Eastern Bengal (with Assam)**.
 - **Capitals:** Calcutta for Bengal and **Dacca** for Eastern Bengal.
- **Official Justification:** The British claimed Bengal's population of **78 million** made administration difficult. **Development of Assam** was also cited as a reason for partition.

Real Motives

- **Weaken Indian Nationalism:** Bengal, the nerve centre of **Indian nationalism**, was to be weakened by splitting it into two provinces.
- **Linguistic and Religious Divisions:** Reduced the **Bengali population** to a minority. Created a **Hindu-majority western** region and a **Muslim-majority eastern** region.
- **British Strategy:** The partition was a deliberate attempt to **divide and rule** by fostering communal divisions between **Hindus and Muslims**.

Effects of Partition

- **Anti-Partition Agitation:** Massive protests emerged across Bengal.
- **Swadeshi Movement:** Economic boycott of British goods, symbolising nationalist defiance.
- **Rise of Extremism:** Sparked a more aggressive stance within the **Indian National Movement**.
- **Formation of Muslim League (1906):** The partition sowed the seeds of communal politics, leading to the formation of the **Muslim League**.

Appealing to Muslims

- **Lord Curzon's Tactics:** By making **Dacca** the capital of the Muslim-majority province, Curzon aimed to secure **Muslim support**.

- **Divide and Rule:** The British sought to counteract the **Congress** and growing nationalism by encouraging **Muslim communalism**.
- **Significance:** The partition intensified **nationalist sentiments** and catalysed the **Swadeshi Movement**, which became a key part of India's freedom struggle, unifying Indians against **British imperialism**.

THE SWADESHI AND BOYCOTT MOVEMENT (1903-1905)

'Swadeshi' and 'Boycott' were adopted as methods of struggle for the first time during the agitation against the Partition of Bengal. [UPSC 2016]

Origin and Causes

- The **Swadeshi Movement** emerged in response to the British decision to partition Bengal, announced in **December 1903**. [UPSC 2016]
- Officially, the partition aimed at improving administrative efficiency, but the real motive was to **weaken Bengal**, a hub of Indian nationalism, by dividing it along **religious and linguistic lines**.
- **Key leaders:** **Surendranath Banerjea, K.K. Mitra**, and **Prithwishchandra Ray**.
- Methods of protest included **petitions, public meetings**, and using **newspapers** such as **Hitabadi, Sanjibani**, and **Bengalee**.
- Despite opposition, the partition was officially announced in **July 1905**, leading to massive protests.

Note: 7th August is declared as the National Handloom Day was first observed in 2015. It was in 1905 that the Swadeshi Movement was launched on the same day. [UPSC 2023]

Key Factors Behind the Movement

- **Partition of Bengal:** Seen as an attempt to divide Hindus and Muslims, sparking anger and resistance.
- **Nationalism:** The rising tide of nationalism in India pushed for self-governance.
- **Economic Exploitation:** Indian discontent with British exploitation, including the **drain of wealth**.
- **Political Repression:** Repressive British policies, including denial of political rights and imprisonment of leaders.

Formal Launch

- On **August 7, 1905**, the **Boycott Resolution** was passed, marking the formal proclamation of the **Swadeshi Movement** [UPSC 2023]

- On **October 16, 1905**, Bengal was officially partitioned. On this day, Indians expressed mourning by fasting, bathing in the **Ganges**, singing **Bande Mataram** (the theme song of the movement), and tying symbolic unity bands.
- **Rabindranath Tagore** composed the song ‘**Amar Sonar Bangla**’, which later became Bangladesh’s national anthem.

Spread of the Movement

- The Swadeshi Movement quickly spread beyond Bengal to regions like **Poona, Bombay, Punjab, Delhi**, and **Madras**.
- In the **Indian National Congress (INC)** session of **1905** at **Benaras** (chaired by **Gopal Krishna Gokhale**), the partition was condemned, and the Swadeshi Movement was endorsed.
- In the **Calcutta session of 1906** (chaired by **Dadabhai Naoroji**), the INC declared **Swaraj** (self-government) as its goal for the first time.
- Disputes between the **Moderates** and **Extremists** over methods led to the **Surat split in 1907**. [UPSC 2015]
- **Key Leaders Across India:** Bengal: Ashwini Kumar Dutta; Madras: V.O. Chidambaram Pillai; Delhi: Syed Hyder Reza; Andhra: T. Prakasam and Krishna Rao; Punjab: Lala Lajpat Rai and Ajit Singh; Bombay & Poona: Bal Gangadhar Tilak
- The Swadeshi Movement contributed to the revival of the indigenous artisan crafts and industries. The National Council of Education was established as a part of the Swadeshi Movement. [UPSC 2019]

New Forms of Struggle in the Freedom Movement

- **Boycott of Foreign Goods:** Mass actions like burning foreign textiles and abstaining from foreign products gained widespread support.
- **Public Gatherings:** Mobilised masses and fostered unity through processions.
- **“Corps of Volunteers”/Samitis:** Local organisations like **Swadesh Bandhab Samiti** and **Swadeshi Sangam** spread nationalist ideas through cultural events and social work.
- **Festivals:** **Tilak’s Ganapati and Shivaji Festivals** became platforms for swadeshi propaganda.
- **Atma-Shakti:** Promoted self-reliance, national pride, and social reforms like caste discrimination and dowry abolition.
- **Swadeshi Education:** **Bengal National College** and **National Schools** promoted indigenous education. **National Council of Education** (August 15, 1906) focused on nationalist education.
- **Swadeshi Enterprises:** Indigenous industries like **textile mills** and **Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company** reduced dependency on British goods. [UPSC 2019]

Impact on Culture

The Swadeshi movement greatly influenced the cultural sphere: **Nationalist Songs:** Rabindranath Tagore and Dwijendralal Ray inspired Indian nationalism, with Tagore’s “Amar Sonar

Bangla” motivating Bangladesh’s liberation struggle. “**Amar Sonar Bangla**”: Composed by **Rabindranath Tagore** during the movement, it later became the national anthem of Bangladesh.

- **Artistic Expressions:** Abanindranath Tagore challenged **Victorian naturalism**, drawing inspiration from traditional Indian art, while **Nandalal Bose** significantly impacted Indian art through the Indian Society of **Oriental Art**.
- **Scientific Contributions:** **Jagdish Chandra Bose** showcased India’s potential for **scientific innovation**.
- **Revival of Traditional Crafts:** promoting **handwoven textiles** and reviving craftsmanship.
- **“Desher Katha” by S.G. Deuskar:** A book summarising the works of **M.G. Ranade** and **D. Naoroji**, warning against the British “**hypnotic conquest of the mind**” and inspiring Swadeshi plays and songs. [UPSC 2020]

Extent of Mass Participation in the Swadeshi Movement

- **Swadeshi Campaign:** Students led picketing against foreign goods.
- **Punitive Actions:** Disaffiliation, job disqualification, scholarships revoked, fines, expulsion, arrest, and physical punishment for participating students.
- **Active Role:** Women engaged in **protests, processions**, and **picketing** during the **Swadeshi movement**.
- **Urban Middle-Class:** Shift to public activism in the national struggle.
- **Varied Support:** Active support from **Maulana Azad**, but many upper/middle-class Muslims distanced due to Hindu-centric symbols.
- **Partition Support:** **Nawab Salimullah** backed **East Bengal** partition for Muslims.
- **British Manipulation:** British promoted the **All India Muslim League (1906)**, deepening divisions.
- **Strikes (1905-1908):** **Burn Company Clerks’ Strike (1905)** Howrah, **East Indian Railway Strike (1906)**, **Jute Mills Strikes (1906-1908)**, and **Rawalpindi Strike** (led by **Lala Lajpat Rai** and **Ajit Singh**).
- **Foreign Mill Strikes:** Led by **Subramaniya Siva** and **Chidambaram Pillai**.

Slow Dissipation Causes

The **Swadeshi Movement** dissipated due to **government repression**, **internal divisions**, and **limited reach** beyond Bengal. **Muslim support** was hindered by **communal divisions** and the formation of the **All India Muslim League (1906)**. **Lack of organisation**, **directionless energy**, and **communal riots** further weakened the movement’s effectiveness.

The Surat Split (1907)

Swadeshi Movement has contributed to a split in the Indian National Congress resulting in the emergence of ‘moderates’ and ‘extremists’. (UPSC 2015). The **Indian National**

Congress (INC) split into **Moderate** and **Extremist** factions during its session in **Surat** in December 1907. This division reflected growing ideological differences over strategies for Indian independence.

- **Reason:** Extremists' lack of faith in the capacity of the moderates to negotiate with the British Government. [UPSC 2016]
- **Consequences of the Split:** After the split, the Congress was primarily controlled by **Moderates**, focusing on self-government through constitutional means.
- **Government Repression:** From 1907 to 1911, the British government enacted strict laws, including:
 - **Seditious Meetings Act** (1907)
 - **Criminal Law Amendment Act** (1908)
 - **Incitement to Offences Act** (1908)
 - **Explosive Substances Act** (1908)
 - **Indian Press Act** (1910)

Key Congress Sessions

- **Benaras (1905)** - Presided by **Gopal Krishna Gokhale**
 - Emergence of **Moderate-Extremist** differences on extending the **Swadeshi Movement**.
 - A mild resolution was passed condemning the **partition of Bengal** to avert an immediate split. [UPSC 2016]
- **Calcutta (1906)** - Presided by **Dadabhai Naoroji**
 - Moderates proposed Naoroji as president; **Extremists** favoured **Tilak** or **Lajpat Rai**.
 - '**Swarajya**' (self-government) was mentioned for the first time, but undefined.
 - Moderates preferred caution and focused on council reforms, while Extremists advocated for **passive resistance** and **boycott**.
- **Surat (1907)** - Presided by **Ras Behari Ghosh**
 - Extremists aimed to have **Tilak** or **Lajpat Rai** as president and pushed for radical resolutions.
 - Moderates insisted on excluding Tilak to drop radical agendas.
 - Firm stances led to an inevitable split
- **Simla Deputation (1906):** A group of **Muslim elites**, led by **Agha Khan**, met **Lord Minto** to demand a separate electorate for Muslims. This group took over the **Muslim League**, initially formed by **Nawab Salimullah** and others, aiming to maintain loyalty to the British and draw Muslim intelligentsia away from the Congress.

MORLEY-MINTO REFORMS OF 1909

The **Morley-Minto Reforms**, formally known as the **Indian Councils Act of 1909**, aimed to address the demands of both Moderates and Muslims amidst rising nationalist sentiments in India.

Key Provisions

- **Expansion of Legislative Councils:** Increased Indian representation, yet the majority remained British officials, ensuring British control.
- **Separate Electorates for Muslims:** Allowed Muslims to elect representatives, marking a significant acknowledgment of communal divisions.
- **Increased Elected Membership:** More elected members in both Imperial and Provincial Legislative Councils, although some were still nominated.
- **Lower Qualifications for Muslims:** Muslims received representation exceeding their population share, with lower income qualifications for voters compared to Hindus.
- **Indirect Elections:** Members were elected indirectly through local bodies, creating a complex electoral process.
- **Empowered Legislatures:** Legislatures could pass resolutions and vote on budget items, but not the budget as a whole.
- **Indian Representation in Executive Council:** **Satyendra Sinha** became the first Indian member of the Viceroy's Executive Council.

Delhi Durbar

- In 1911, **Lord Hardinge** organised a Durbar in Delhi, which was attended by the British Monarch **King George V** and **Queen Mary**.
- Announcements in Delhi Durbar:
 - Bengal Partition was revoked. [UPSC 2014]
 - British India's capital shifted from Calcutta to Delhi.
- **Delhi Conspiracy Case:** **Rash Bihari Bose** and **Sachindra Nath Sanyal** extremist revolutionaries tried to throw a bomb on Hardinge.
 - **Sachindra Nath Sanyal** was jailed during which he wrote **Bandi Jeevan**.

Annulment of Partition 1911

[UPSC 2014]

King George V abrogated **Curzon's Act** as the **Royal Durbar in Delhi in 1911**. In 1911, the British government, under **Viceroy Lord Hardinge**, annulled the **Partition of Bengal (1905)** due to increasing **unrest** and pressure from the **Swadeshi** and **Boycott Movement**. Officially, the annulment was justified as an **administrative necessity**, claiming better governance for a unified Bengal.

REVOLUTIONARY ACTIVITIES IN INDIA

Phases of Revolutionary Nationalism

- **First Phase:** Followed the decline of the **Swadeshi Movement** (until 1917).
- **Second Phase:** Arising post the **Non-Cooperation Movement**.

Factors Contributing to Revolutionary Activities:

The decline of moderate leadership, particularly under **Lord Curzon**, and weak post-Swadeshi leadership led to disillusionment, prompting young nationalists to adopt revolutionary tactics for independence.

Methods Employed by Revolutionaries

- Revolutionaries adopted several methods, including:
 - **Acts of Heroism:** They organised **assassinations** of unpopular officials and informers within their ranks.
 - **Swadeshi Dacoities:** Conducted **robberies** to raise funds for their revolutionary activities.
 - **Military Conspiracies:** During **World War I**, some revolutionaries planned military actions with the hope of support from Britain's enemies.

Manifestations of Revolutionary Activities

- **Violent Uprisings:** The **Kakori Train Robbery** in **1924** and the **Chittagong Armory Raid** in **1930** were significant instances of direct assaults on British authority.
- **Political Assassinations:** Growing discontent with moderate approaches led revolutionaries to attempt the elimination of unpopular British officials both in India and abroad.
- **Secret Societies:** Groups such as the **Hindustan Republican Association** and **Jugantar** organised and executed various revolutionary activities, including **bombings** and **assassinations**.

Revolutionary Activities(Phase : 1907-17)

Case/Organization (Year) and Place	Associated People and Description
The Anushilan Samiti (1902) - Bengal	• Founded by Promotha Mitter and others, including Jatindranath Banerjee, Barindra Kumar Ghosh. • Published journals Yugantar and Sandhya Prakash. • Advocated revolutionary activities like Swadeshi Dacoities, physical training, and moral education.
Attempt on Sir Fuller's life (1907) - Bengal	• An attempt by Yugantar on Sir Fuller, Lt. Governor of Eastern Bengal and Assam. • Fuller eventually resigned from his post.
Muzaffarpur Case (1908)/Alipore Conspiracy Case/Manicktolla Bomb Conspiracy (1908) - Bengal	• Prafulla Chaki and Khudiram Bose attempted to kill Muzaffarpur Magistrate Kingsford. • Aurobindo Ghosh was acquitted in the Alipore Conspiracy Case. • Khudiram Bose was hanged for the attempt. • Barindra Kumar Ghosh was sentenced to life imprisonment.
Barrah Dacoity (1908) - Bengal	• It was carried out by Dacca Anushilan under Pulin Das to fund revolutionary activities.
Delhi Conspiracy Case (1912) - Delhi	• Attempt by Rash Behari Bose and Sachindra Sanyal to assassinate Viceroy Hardinge. • The conspiracy was aimed at detonating a bomb near the Viceroy's procession.
German Plot/Zimmerman Plan (1916-17) - Bengal	• Led by Jatindranath Mukherjee (Bagha Jatin) and Yugantar to plan an armed insurrection during World War I. • The plan included importing German arms to provoke rebellion in India. • Activities involved Swadeshi Dacoities and boat dacoities to raise funds.
Ramosi Peasant Force (1879) - Maharashtra	• Organised by Vasudev Balwant Phadke to instigate an armed revolt against British authorities.
Chapekar Brothers Case (1897) - Maharashtra	• Damodar and Balkrishna (Chapekar brothers) assassinated Plague Commissioner Rand and Lt. Ayerst as revenge for repressive plague policies.
Mitra Mela (1899) - Maharashtra	• Founded by V.D. Savarkar and his brother, merged with Abhinav Bharat in 1904, influenced by Mazzini's Young Italy.
Killing of District Magistrate of Nasik (1909) - Maharashtra	• Anant Lakshman Kanhere, a member of Abhinav Bharat, killed A.M.T. Jackson, the Collector of Nashik. • Resulted in Kanhere's execution and Savarkar's imprisonment.
Punjab Extremism - Punjab	• Lala Lajpat Rai initiated Punjabee and Anjuman-i-Mohisban-i-Watan in Lahore. • Revolutionaries included Lala Hardayal, Bhai Parmanand, and Syed Haider Raza. • Shifted from grievances to extremism after British repression.

Assassination of Robert Ash (1911) - Madras	• Vanchi Iyer assassinated Robert Asch, the District Collector of Tirunelveli.
Bharat Swashashan Samiti / Indian Home Rule Society (India House) (1905) - London	• Founded by Shyamji Krishnavarma as a revolutionary hub for Indian nationalists. • Key figures included Savarkar and Hardayal, who published The Indian Sociologist. • Inspired revolutionaries in Paris, Geneva, and London.
Assassination of Curzon-Wyllie (1909) - London	• Madanlal Dhingra assassinated Curzon-Wyllie in London, protesting British rule.
The Ghadar Party (1913) - San Francisco (North America)	• Founded by Sohan Singh Bhakna, Lala Hardayal, Ramchandra, Bhawan Singh, Kartar Singh Saaraba, Barkatullah, and Bhai Premchand. • Aimed at sparking an all-India uprising, with support from Germany during World War I. [UPSC 2022] • Involved organising assassinations, anti-imperialist literature, and procuring arms for rebellion.
Berlin Committee for Indian Independence (1915) - Berlin (Germany)	• Led by Virendranath Chattopadhyaya, Bhupendranath Dutta, Lala Hardayal with German support under the Zimmerman Plan. • Aimed at organising rebellion and provoking an armed invasion of British India.
Missions to Baghdad, Persia, Turkey, and Kabul - Various	• Led by revolutionaries Raja Mahendra Pratap Singh, Barkatullah, and Obaidullah Sindhi. • Attempted to form an Indian government in Kabul, with support from Afghanistan's Crown Prince Amanullah.
Singapore Mutiny (Feb 15, 1915) - Singapore	• Led by Jamadar Chisti Khan, Jamadar Abdul Gani, and Subedar Daud Khan, involving the 5th Light Infantry and 36th Sikh Battalion. • The mutiny was suppressed, resulting in executions and life sentences.

Note: Phase -II of the Revolutionary Activities of the 1920s has been covered in Chapter 6.

The Ghadar Revolution

The **Ghadar Party** was a revolutionary group headquartered in **San Francisco**, with branches in the **Far East** and along the **US coast**. Its weekly newspaper, "**The Ghadar**," spearheaded its activities. [UPSC 2014]

Emergence of the Ghadar Party

- Formed in **May 1913** by **Lala Har Dayal** and others, the Ghadar Party aimed to fight **British rule in India** through **armed revolt**, not petitions.
- The **Hindi Association** was established, leading to the launch of "**The Ghadar**" and the founding of **Yugantar Ashram** in San Francisco.
- **Key Figures:** Prominent leaders included **Sohan Singh Bhakna**, **Lala Hardayal**, **Kartar Singh Sarabha**, and **Bhagwan Singh**, who led **extensive propaganda efforts**. Kartar Singh Sarabha and Raghubar Dayal Gupta returned to India to lead the revolt.
- **Rashbehari Bose and Sachin Sanyal** organized the uprising and led political dacoities targeting moneylenders to raise funds. Women like Gulab Kaur ("Ghadri Gulab Kaur"), Bhikaji Cama, Agnes Smedley, Kartar Kaur, Rani Bhagwan Kaur, Sushila Mohan, Bhagwati Giri, and Janki Devi played crucial roles in the Ghadar Party, organizing support, spreading revolutionary ideas, providing safe houses, raising funds, and raising international awareness for India's independence. [UPSC 2022]

- **Literary Contribution:** The first issue of "**The Ghadar**" appeared in **November 1913**, featuring bold critiques of British rule and calls for a **second revolt**. The paper serialised **Savarkar's "The First War of Indian Independence — 1857"** and referenced leaders like **Tilak** and **Aurobindo**.
- **Ghadar Di Goonj – Revolutionary Poetry:** "**Ghadar di Goonj**", a collection of **revolutionary poems**, urged **unity** across religions and encouraged **armed rebellion**. The poems were recited at gatherings, transforming **Punjabi immigrants** from loyalists into **revolutionaries**.
- **Global Impact:** The newspaper spread globally, reaching Indian communities in **Asia**, the **Malay States**, and **Trinidad**, igniting revolutionary fervour. The **Komagata Maru incident** and **World War I** further accelerated the push for **immediate action**.

Komagata Maru Incident and Ghadar Movement

- **Komagata Maru Incident (1914):** Sikh and Punjabi Muslim immigrants, led by **Gurdit Singh**, were denied entry to Canada. After a standoff, the ship returned to **Calcutta**, and **22 passengers** died in a confrontation at **Budge Budge**. This event fueled anti-British sentiment and inspired the **Ghadar Movement**.

- **Ghadar Rebellion (1915):** Activists planned revolts in **Ferozepur, Lahore, and Rawalpindi**, but the plot was betrayed. **45 leaders** were executed, including **Ali brothers, Maulana Azad, and Hasrat Mohani**.
- **Komagata Maru Journey:** Chartered to challenge **discriminatory laws**, activists spread revolutionary ideas in Japan. After being denied entry, the ship returned, inciting protests during **World War I**.
- **Impact on Ghadar:** The incident led to the **Ailan-e-Jung (Proclamation of War)**. Leaders like **Mohammed Barkatullah and Kartar Singh Sarabha** rallied support, but British intelligence foiled the plan.
- **British Suppression:** The **Ingress into India Ordinance** arrested returning revolutionaries. The movement failed due to lack of **mass support** in **Punjab**, ending with executions.
- **Under Defence of India Rules (1915),** rebellious regiments disbanded, 45 leaders hanged, and others arrested and deported. Rashbehari Bose fled to Japan; Sachin Sanyal was transported for life. Pan-Islamists like Ali brothers, Maulana Azad, and Hasrat Mohani were interned. Leader **Lala Hardayal** was seen as unsuited for organizational leadership.

FIRST WORLD WAR AND NATIONALIST RESPONSE

The First World War revitalised the Indian nationalist movement, presenting opportunities for political progress amidst the challenges faced by Britain.

- **World War Alliances:** The First World War saw two factions:
 - **Allies:** Britain, France, Russia, USA, Italy, Japan.
 - **Central Powers:** Germany, Austria-Hungary, Turkey.
- **Indian Responses:**
 - **Moderates:** Supported British efforts as a duty.
 - **Extremists:** Led by figures like **Bal Gangadhar Tilak**, hoped for self-governance as a reward for loyalty.
 - **Revolutionaries:** Aimed for immediate independence, viewing the war as an opportunity to challenge British rule.
- **Impact of British Repression:** Suppression of anti-colonial publications and internment of leaders (e.g., Ali brothers, Maulana Azad) intensified anti-imperialist sentiments among the 'Young Party'.
- **Financial Strain on India:** The war depleted troop numbers, reducing white soldiers to around 15,000, while also opening possibilities for support from Germany and Turkey.
- **Nationalist Movements:** The war's onset re-energized nationalism, drawing on the earlier **Swadeshi Movement**. Various factions emerged:

- **Ghadar Revolutionaries** in North America sought violent rebellion.
- **Home Rule Leagues** like **Annie Besant** and **Lokamanya Tilak** campaigned for **Swaraj**.

Significant Events

- **Congress Sessions:**
 - In **December 1914**, the Congress session in Madras openly supported the British war efforts, marking the first time a Governor attended a Congress session.
 - In **1916**, a joint session of the Congress and **Muslim League** in Lucknow saw **Jinnah** and **Ambika Charan Majumdar** presiding over unified discussions.

HOME RULE LEAGUE MOVEMENT

The primary goal was **self-government (home rule)** for India within the British Empire, inspired by similar demands in Ireland.

- **Leaders:** **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** and **Annie Besant** were the most prominent leaders. [UPSC 2013]
- Others include **G.S. Khaparde, Joseph Baptista, Muhammad Ali Jinnah, Motilal Nehru, Jawaharlal Nehru, Bhulabhai Desai, Chittaranjan Das, K.M. Munshi, B. Chakravarti, Saifuddin Kitchlew, Madan Mohan Malaviya, Tej Bahadur Sapru, Lala Lajpat Rai, and Sir S. Subramania Iyer** (who renounced his knighthood).
- The movement attracted moderate Congress members and some from Gokhale's **Servants of India Society**. However, Anglo-Indians, many Muslims, and non-Brahmins in the South did not participate due to concerns of potential Hindu-majority rule.
- In 1920, All India Home Rule League changed its name to "**Swarajya Sabha**" [UPSC 2018]
- **Two separate leagues emerged in 1916:**
 - **Tilak's League:** April 1916, headquartered in Poona, covered Maharashtra (except Bombay), Karnataka, and Central Provinces.
 - **Besant's League:** September 1916 in Madras, covered the rest of India, including Bombay City.

Factors Leading to the Movement

- **Disillusionment with Morley-Minto Reforms** and dissatisfaction with British governance.
- **Economic Hardships** due to war: High taxes, rising prices, and poverty.
- **Shattering of White Superiority Myth** post-World War I exposed imperialism's vulnerabilities.
- **Tilak's Leadership:** After his release in 1914, Tilak adopted a more conciliatory stance toward the British while advocating for **Swarajya**.

Tilak's Home Rule League

- Tilak's release in June 1914 enabled him to assume leadership and make conciliatory gestures towards the government and Moderates.

- Tilak aimed for reform in administration and urged cooperation with the British government in times of crisis.
- **Establishment:** April 1916.
 - Tilak held his **first** Home Rule meeting at **Belgaum**.
 - **Poona** was the **headquarters** of his league.
 - First President: Joseph Baptista and Secretary: N.C Kelkar
- **Coverage:** Restricted to Maharashtra (excluding Bombay city), Karnataka, Central Provinces, and Berar.
- **Branches:** Six branches.
- **Demands:** Swarajya (self-rule), Formation of linguistic states and Vernacular education
- **Methods:** Published pamphlets in regional languages, engaged in village education, and emphasised **linguistic states** and **vernacular education**.
- **Key Message:** India was “mature enough” for self-rule, and the focus was on **linguistic equality**. **Besant’s Home Rule League**
- Inspired by the Irish Home Rule Leagues, Annie Besant (an Irish theosophist in India since 1896) expanded her activities to build a movement for home rule.
- **Establishment:** September 1916 in Madras (now Chennai). **[UPSC 2013]**
- **Secretary:** George Arundale
- **Coverage:** Covered the rest of India, including Bombay City.
- **Branches:** 200 branches
- **Objectives:** Similar to white colonies demanded for self-government for India after the war. She campaigned through her newspapers, **New India** and **Commonweal**, and through public meetings and conferences.
- **Organisational Structure:** Loosely organised
- **Key Figures:** George Arundale: Organizing secretary, B.W. Wadia and C.P. Ramaswamy Aiyar: Played significant roles in the league.

Government Response

- **Repression:** The British government imposed restrictions, especially in Madras, banning students from political activities.
- **Arrests:** In **June 1917**, Annie Besant and her associates were arrested, leading to nationwide protests.

End of the League Movement (By 1919): Key Factors

- **Weak Organisation:** Lack of a solid organisational structure and coordination.
- **Sectarian Unrest:** Religious conflicts in 1917-18 diverted attention.
- **Appeasing Moderates:** Promises of reforms (Montagu’s 1917 statement) and Besant’s release pacified moderates.
- **Extremist Influence:** Extremists’ call for passive resistance discouraged moderate involvement.

- **Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms:** The 1918 reforms divided nationalist leaders.
- **Leadership Vacuum:** Tilak’s absence and Besant’s indecision left the movement leaderless.
- In **1920**, Gandhi transformed Besant’s **Home Rule League** into the **Swarajya Sabha**, aligning it with the **Indian National Congress**. **[UPSC 2018]**
- “Shiva ..cut his wife into fifty-two pieces only to discover that he had fifty-two wives. This is what happens to the Government of India when it interns Mrs Besant.”- **Montagu**.

LUCKNOW SESSION OF THE INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS (1916)

The **Lucknow Session** (1916), presided by **Ambika Charan Majumdar**, reunited **Moderates** and **Extremists** after a 10-year split. Key developments:

- **Readmission of Extremists:** Bal Gangadhar Tilak and followers reintegrated.
- **Factors:** Diminished old **controversies**, recognition of political **stagnation**, efforts by **Annie Besant** and **Tilak** for reconciliation, and Tilak’s support for **administrative reforms**.
- **Passing of Leaders:** Deaths of **Gopal Krishna Gokhale** and **Pherozeshah Mehta** removed opposition to Extremists.

LUCKNOW PACT (1916)

The **Lucknow Pact** (1916) was an alliance between **Indian National Congress** and the **Muslim League** to present unified demands to the British. Key Factors include:

- **Muslim Dissatisfaction:** Refusal to aid Turkey, **Bengal Partition annulment (1911)**, and denial of **Aligarh University** affiliation.
- **League’s Leadership Shift:** **1912 Calcutta Session** saw a move towards self-government.
- **World War I Impact:** Repression fueled anti-imperialist sentiment.
- **Key Leaders:** **Lokmanya Tilak** and **Mohammad Ali Jinnah** emphasised Hindu-Muslim unity.

Main Clauses:

- **Self-Government** as the goal.
- **One-third Muslim representation** in the central government.
- **Separate electorates.**
- **Weightage system** in legislative representation.
- **Strength of Central Legislative Council:** 150 members.
- **Four-fifths provincial legislators elected.**
- **Adult franchise** for direct elections.
- **Veto power** on community bills.
- **Separation of Executive and Judiciary.**

Nationalist Resurgence Post-World War I (1919)

Post-World War I, India's nationalism surged due to economic distress, unfulfilled promises, and global ideological shifts:

- **Economic Hardships:** Industrial downturn, unemployment, and high taxes burdened workers, peasants, and returning soldiers.
- **Political Betrayal:** Wartime contributions led to unmet political promises, fueling discontent.
- **Global Anti-Imperial Sentiment:** Disillusionment post-Paris Peace Conference and the **Russian Revolution (1917)** inspired resistance movements.
- **Nationalist Revival:** Economic, political, and global factors sparked India's renewed independence struggle.

MONTAGU'S DECLARATION OF AUGUST 1917

- **Shift in British Stance:** The Declaration marked a significant change, acknowledging India's desire for **self-governance** and moving away from previous reform stances.
- **'Responsible Government' Concept:** It emphasised the **progressive realisation** of **responsible government**, where rulers would be accountable to **elected Indian representatives** rather than solely to the British.

Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (Government of India Act, 1919)

The Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms of 1919, led by Edwin Montagu (Secretary of State for India) and Lord Chelmsford (Viceroy), aimed to introduce constitutional changes in India, culminating in the Government of India Act of 1919. [UPSC 2016]. **The Government of India Act of 1919 clearly defined the jurisdiction of the central and provincial Governments.** [UPSC 2015]

Key Features of the Act: [UPSC 2015]

- **Provincial Government - Introduction of Dyarchy:** **Dyarchy means division of the subjects delegated to the provinces into two categories.** [UPSC 2017]. Dyarchy introduced a **dual system** of governance at the provincial level.
- Executive authority is divided into **"reserved"** and **"transferred"** subjects; **Reserved subjects** (e.g., law and order, finance) were under the control of the governor and his executive council of bureaucrats; **Transferred subjects** (e.g., education, health) were administered by ministers nominated from elected members of the legislative council, responsible to the legislature. [UPSC 2022]; No responsibility of executive councillors

to the legislature; The Governor could take over the administration of transferred subjects in case of failure of constitutional machinery.; The Secretary of State and Governor-General can interfere in reserved subjects only.

- **Provincial Legislature:** Expanded provincial legislative councils to **70% elected members.**; Consolidated system of communal and class electorates.; Granted **voting rights to women.** [UPSC 2021]
- Legislature could initiate legislation but required the governor's assent.; The governor had **veto power** and authority to restore rejected budgets.
- **Central Government - No Responsible Government**
 - No provision for responsible government at the all-India level.
 - The Governor-General remained the **chief executive authority.**
 - Central and provincial lists for administration.
 - Viceroy's executive council **included three Indian members.**
 - The Governor-General retained control over reserved subjects in provinces.
 - The Governor-General had **powers to restore** budget cuts, certify bills, and issue ordinances.
- **Central Legislature**
 - Introduced **bicameral legislature** - Central Legislative Assembly (145 members) and Council of State (60 members).
 - The Council of State had a five-year tenure, consisting only of male members.
 - The Central Legislative Assembly had a three-year tenure.
 - Legislators had limited control over the budget; 75% of the budget was non-votable.
 - Some Indian representation in important committees, including finance.
 - The Government of India Act, 1919 made an important change— **the Secretary of State for India** was henceforth to be **paid out of the British exchequer.**
- **Congress Reaction**
 - The **Congress Party**, led by **Hasan Imam**, deemed the reforms "disappointing" and "unsatisfactory," calling for effective **self-government.**
 - **Tilak** - "Unworthy and Disappointing- a Sunless dawn".
 - **Annie Besant** - "Unworthy of England to offer and India to accept".

